

WORKING PRODUCT BRIEF

Social Hydration App

A free water-tracking app built around friends, competition, progression and cosmetics.

Core thesis

Do not monetize hydration. Monetize the fun around it: identity, status, social capacity, cosmetics and acceleration.

Inspiration: the social energy of GymRats + the visual charm of modern habit apps + game-style progression and economy.

1. Product Vision

The product should not feel like “another water tracker”. The tracker is the infrastructure; the social game is the retention engine.

- Hydration action: record a drink in one or two taps.
- Habit action: maintain goals, streaks and achievements.
- Social action: see friends, react, compete and invite others.
- Progression action: gain non-purchasable prestige and collectible medals.
- Economy action: earn or buy currency and spend it on social expansion and cosmetics.

Positioning idea

A social app where the habit being played is hydration - not simply a hydration utility with a social tab.

2. Product Principles

Hydration basics stay free: Custom drink quantity, goals, reminders, history and normal tracking should never be held behind an expensive paywall.

Never reward over-drinking: Competitive score is based on consistency and percentage of a personal target, not raw liters. Reaching 150% should not beat someone who safely reached 100%.

Prestige cannot be purchased: Global/competitive reputation is earned only through real app participation, streaks, achievements and contests.

Money buys expression and convenience: Purchased currency can unlock cosmetics, themes, extra social capacity and similar non-competitive value.

Social features are first-class: Groups, challenges, leaderboards, reactions and invitations should be part of V1 rather than “later”.

The core action must be fast: Recording 300 ml or 750 ml should feel instant. The app should learn frequently used amounts and surface them prominently.

3. The Five Product Loops

Loop	Core sequence	Why it matters
Hydration loop	Drink -> record -> immediate visual/audio feedback -> daily progress.	Keeps the utility useful every day.

Loop	Core sequence	Why it matters
Habit loop	Daily goal -> streak -> achievement -> reason to return tomorrow.	Creates personal retention.
Social loop	Friends -> groups -> reactions -> rivalry -> invitations -> more friends.	Creates accountability and organic acquisition.
Competition loop	Contests -> seasons -> medals -> reputation -> status.	Creates long-term goals and status.
Economy loop	Achievements/ads/purchases -> Drops -> cosmetics/social capacity -> more engagement.	Monetizes engagement without breaking the tracker.

4. Core Hydration Experience

4.1 Basic tracking

- Flexible custom quantities - e.g. 250 ml, 300 ml, 350 ml, 500 ml, 600 ml, 750 ml or any custom value.
- Quick-add presets based on the user's most frequent quantities.
- Personal daily target and clear progress toward it.
- Notifications/reminders with user-controlled frequency.
- History and basic charts available for free.
- Water plus common beverages such as coffee, tea and juice; the free tier should remain genuinely useful.

4.2 Pleasant feedback

- Satisfying micro-animations when a drink is logged.
- Pleasant optional sounds/haptics.
- A character/mascot that reacts to progress, streaks and achievements.
- Visual progression that makes a one-second tracking action feel rewarding.

5. Social System

5.1 Friends and groups

- Add friends and create/join private groups.
- Free accounts start with 1-2 active group slots.
- Additional group capacity can be permanently unlocked with internal currency.
- Invites should use shareable links/QR codes and deep-link directly into a group or contest.

- Reactions and lightweight social interactions should make progress visible without requiring long posts.

5.2 Viral invitation loop

Example

“Gustavo invited you to Hydration September - 12 participants - Join challenge.” The invitation itself should be the acquisition mechanism, not a generic “download this app” message.

5.3 Social feed/event stream

Water intake alone is repetitive, so the feed should emphasize meaningful events rather than every single sip:

- “Ana completed a 30-day streak.”
- “Pedro passed you in Hydration September.”
- “Lucas is about to lose a 32-day streak.”
- “Gustavo reached #1 in the group.”
- “Ana unlocked Ocean Master.”
- Optional photos attached to meaningful updates, not required for every drink.

6. Competition and Ranking

6.1 Group ranking

Rank users primarily by consistency against their own personal goals. A simple conceptual rule is shown below.

Conceptual scoring rule

Daily competitive score = $\min(\% \text{ of personal target}, 100\%) + \text{approved bonuses}$

6.2 Global prestige score

A second point system should represent reputation/prestige. It can never be bought and is not awarded for watching ads.

Action	Prestige treatment
Daily target completed	Example: +100
7-day streak	Example: +150
30-day streak	Example: +500

Action	Prestige treatment
Rare achievement	Example: +300
Contest - 1st / 2nd / 3rd	Example: +500 / +300 / +150
Complete a challenge	Example: +100
Purchased Drops	0 prestige
Rewarded ads	0 prestige

6.3 Leaderboards

- Friends leaderboard.
- Country leaderboard.
- Global leaderboard.
- Season leaderboard that resets periodically.
- All-time prestige leaderboard that never resets.

6.4 Leagues

Optional league progression can add a Duolingo-like competitive layer independent of friend groups: Bronze -> Silver -> Gold -> Platinum -> Diamond. Weekly performance can promote or demote users while lifetime prestige remains permanent.

7. Contests, Seasons and Events

7.1 Private/community contests

- Groups can run 7-day, 30-day or custom contests.
- Examples: office challenge, gym friends challenge, university group or family challenge.
- Winners receive medals, Drops and prestige - but winning is based on healthy adherence, not maximum volume consumed.
- Future monetization possibility: a limited number of active contests for free, with additional contest capacity unlockable through Drops.

7.2 Official themed contests

The app can run recurring global events that make hydration feel like a live game. Examples:

Theme	Concept	Reward idea
Coffee Lovers Week	Log coffee on several days while still completing the hydration goal.	Coffee-themed medal / barista cosmetic.
Juice Lovers	Participate consistently with juice-related goals.	Juice medal / fruit cosmetic.

Theme	Concept	Reward idea
Tea Week	Tea participation plus normal hydration adherence.	Tea medal / themed cosmetic.
Summer Hydration	Seasonal consistency event.	Limited seasonal medal/theme.
Workout Hydration	Hydration adherence around workout days.	Sport-themed badge/cosmetic.
Coconut Water / Lemon Water / Ice Cold	Short novelty events.	Collectible event rewards.

7.3 Limited medals and history

Some medals should become permanently unobtainable after an event ends. A “Coffee Lovers 2026” medal can remain visible forever and be replaced by a visually different “Coffee Lovers 2027” medal the next year. This creates account history, collection value and status for early users.

8. Economy: Drops vs. Prestige

Simple rule

Drops buy things. Prestige proves things.

System	Can be purchased?	Earned from	Used for
Drops - internal currency	Yes	Achievements, streaks, contest rewards, rewarded ads, purchases	Cosmetics, themes, group slots, optional social capacity
Prestige / Reputation	No	Real participation, achievements, streaks, contest results	Leaderboards, status, leagues, permanent profile progression

8.1 Example ways to earn Drops

- Complete daily target: small reward.
- 7-day / 30-day streak milestones: larger reward.
- Achievements: reward scales with rarity/difficulty.
- Contest participation and podium placement.
- League promotion or season reward.
- Rewarded ad: user voluntarily watches an ad in exchange for Drops, with a sensible daily cap.
- In-app purchase: buy Drops directly.

8.2 Social capacity as a currency sink

A core monetization concept is to limit active group capacity while keeping the tracker free.

Example balancing direction:

Group capacity	Example unlock cost
1st group	Free
2nd group	Free
3rd slot	~800 Drops
4th slot	~1,500 Drops
5th slot	~2,500 Drops
6th slot	~4,000 Drops

Important: the unlock should increase permanent account capacity (for example, 2 -> 3 active groups), not charge again every time the user switches groups.

8.3 Avoid blocking the viral loop

The group limit must monetize heavy social users without making invitations frustrating. Possible safeguards:

- Make the first extra slot realistically earnable through normal use.
- Allow some temporary official challenges without consuming a permanent group slot.
- Never require payment merely to accept the user's first social invitation.
- Use progressively higher prices for later slots, monetizing highly engaged users rather than beginners.

9. Characters, Cosmetics and Status

- Character/mascot skins.
- Clothing, hats, glasses and accessories.
- Background environments/themes.
- Drink logging visual effects and optional sounds.
- Profile frames, emotes and reactions.
- Contest- or season-exclusive cosmetics.
- Rare cosmetics earned only through achievements/competitions and never sold.

Critical design point: cosmetics are more valuable when other users can see them in profiles, leaderboards, group views and contest results. They become social status, not just private decoration.

9.1 Possible rarity model

Rarity	Example price	Role
Common	200-500 Drops	Easy personalization
Rare	800-1,500	Aspirational but obtainable
Epic	2,000-4,000	Longer-term goal
Legendary	5,000+	Status / high-value sink
Earned-only	Not purchasable	True prestige from events or achievements

10. Monetization Philosophy

Monetization rule

The user can pay with time, engagement or money - but should not need to pay to hydrate correctly.

- Occasional non-intrusive ads at natural breaks.
- Rewarded ads for Drops as an explicit user choice.
- Direct purchase of Drops through platform in-app purchases.
- Cosmetics and themes as the primary aspirational purchases.
- Extra group/social capacity as a functional but non-core currency sink.
- Optional future supporter subscription only for convenience/value-add (for example no ads + cosmetic allowance), not for core tracking.

Avoid: paywalling basic quantities, reminders, normal hydration tracking or other functionality necessary to use the app properly.

11. Suggested MVP

The initial goal is to test whether social competition around hydration produces real retention. Build the smallest version that can validate that behavior.

Priority	Scope
Must have	Account/profile; personal hydration goal; custom quick-add amounts; reminders; daily progress; streak; simple achievements; friends; invite links; private groups; 1-2 free group slots; group leaderboard; simple contest; reactions; basic character; basic Drops; basic prestige.

Priority	Scope
Good next	Seasonal/global leaderboard; official themed contests; cosmetics shop; rewarded ads; purchased Drops; extra group slots; collectible event medals; richer feed events.
Later	Apple Watch; deep Health integrations; advanced beverage analytics; large cosmetic catalog; complex league system; sophisticated charts; AI beverage recognition; extensive widgets.

11.1 What the MVP must prove

- Do users care about passing friends in a hydration leaderboard?
- Does joining a group improve D7 / D30 retention?
- Do users invite other people without being prompted repeatedly?
- Do contests create noticeable return behavior?
- Do achievements/streaks feel meaningful when tied to prestige and Drops?
- Will users voluntarily watch rewarded ads for currency?
- Which currency sinks matter more: cosmetics or extra social capacity?

12. Example Daily Experience

1. Open the app and immediately see personal progress plus the most relevant group/contest state.
2. Tap a learned quick-add button such as “+350 ml”.
3. Receive a short satisfying animation/sound and character reaction.
4. See progress toward the daily goal, streak and contest score update.
5. Notice a social event: a friend passed you, reacted, completed a streak or is close to losing one.
6. Return later because of a reminder, rivalry, streak or event goal.
7. At milestones, receive Drops, prestige, medals or cosmetics that reinforce longer-term progression.

13. Profile and Long-Term Identity

A mature profile could communicate account history at a glance:

Example profile

Gustavo | Diamond League | 18,430 Prestige | 74-day streak | 12 Gold Medals | Coffee Lovers 2026 | Summer Hydration 2026 | selected character + cosmetic loadout

This turns the account into a collection and social identity rather than a disposable utility tracker.

14. Growth Ideas

- Challenge invite links as the primary viral loop.
- Shareable cards for streaks, medals, rankings and seasonal results.
- Small real communities first: friends, gyms, offices, university groups, running groups and Discord communities.
- Short-form video that demonstrates rivalry/gameplay rather than explaining hydration science.
- Launch in Portuguese and English early so the product is not limited to a lower-ad-value market.
- Use themed events as recurring reasons to post, invite and return.

15. Open Product Questions to Validate

- What should the app/mascot/currency actually be called?
- Are 1 or 2 free group slots optimal?
- How quickly should a normal user be able to earn the first extra group slot?
- Should official contests consume a group slot?
- How should daily competitive scoring handle missed days and partially completed goals?
- How long should a season last: weekly, monthly or quarterly?
- How much of the feed should be automatic events versus user-created posts/photos?
- Which beverages should count toward hydration progress and which should only count toward themed event participation?
- How aggressive can ads be before they hurt retention?
- Which rewards should be earn-only to preserve authentic status?

16. One-Sentence Product Definition

Product definition

A genuinely free hydration tracker that turns consistency into a social game through friends, groups, contests, permanent prestige, collectible medals and a cosmetic economy.

Working rule to remember: “Never monetize the water. Monetize the world around the water.”